more than that in opportunity cost. Basically, the less money you spend on housing—whether that's rent or mortgage—the less wealth you destroy. The more affordable your lifestyle, the more options you have, and the better off you'll be financially.

Instead of buying a massive dream home under the impression that it's an investment, you could use your savings to start a chili food truck business with your secret recipe and make millions.

Chilions?

Sorry, we couldn't resist.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

- The longer you plan to stay in a house, the more likely your choice to buy rather than rent will prove a good one. The goal is for a combination of loan paydown and increase in property value over time to offset the high transactional costs of buying and selling a house.
- The more potential for appreciation your property has, the better off you'll be buying relative to renting. Appreciation is a tricky thing to plan around, but there's no denying it's a powerful force. There are some tricks you can use to force appreciation's hand, which we'll cover in Chapter Three.
- Say it again for the people in the back: Buying a house is not an investment. It's not always a bad choice, but it's not an *investment*.
- We made our first food pun. Didn't we tell you there would be some terrible jokes in here?